

CTEC 121

Introduction to Programming and Problem Solving · Fall 2026

MATERIALS COST

\$0

No textbook, no fees

EVERYTHING IS DUE

Sundays

11:59 PM

THEN IT STAYS OPEN

3 more days

Full credit, no questions

TIME TO BUDGET

~10 hrs/wk

5 in class, 5 outside

Do these five things in week one

- 1 Log into **Canvas** and read the announcements at the top.
- 2 Work through **Module 0** — coding environment, Slack, GitHub.
- 3 Join the class **Slack**. No invite? Message me.
- 4 Open **cs50.dev** and sign in with your GitHub account — that's where you'll write your code.
- 5 Start **Module 1**: Lab 0, Problem Set 0, Collaborative 0.

The rules that actually matter

Deadlines. Weekly work is due Sunday 11:59 PM Pacific and stays open three more days, to Wed 11:59 PM, at full credit — no penalty, no permission needed. Canvas will stamp it “late.” Ignore the label. In-class work and the final project are outside that window.

AI. The CS50 Duck (cs50.ai) is always allowed. No other AI may write, complete, or suggest code you submit unless an assignment says otherwise; using one to explain a concept or an error message is fine — cite it in a comment. The standard: you must be able to explain why it works and change it on request, unaided. You'll code in **cs50.dev**, which has AI autocomplete already turned off.

In-class, on paper. A short quiz most Mondays — eight in all, lowest dropped, and that drop is the make-up — plus the midterm **Wed, Oct 28**, and the final exam **Mon, Nov 30**. None has a three-day window. Need DAC testing? Set up both exams in week one; book Nov 30 by **Fri, Nov 20**.

Participation is 25% — graded on effort, not correctness. Show your reasoning and a wrong answer still earns full credit.

Attendance. Come to both sessions. Miss one? Message me on Slack and I'll give you an equivalent for the in-class work.

Where to get help

Stuck on the material → Slack me, or come to student hours (Zoom link in Canvas)

Stuck on your code → the CS50 Duck at cs50.ai, or ask in Slack

Canvas or software trouble → Tech Hub, Scarpelli 135 · techhub@clark.edu · 360-992-2010

Free tutoring → Clark Tutoring Services, in person or Zoom

Accommodations → Disability Access Center, PUB 002 · dac@clark.edu · 360-992-2314

Food, housing, money → Basic Needs Hub, Gaiser 216 · basicneeds@clark.edu · 360-992-2766

Need a computer → open computer labs, or borrow a laptop through Clark ITS

Your grade

Discussion, participation & collaboration	25%
Problem sets	20%
Final project	20%
Midterm	10%
Quizzes (weekly, in class)	10%
Final exam	10%
Labs	5%

GRADE	A	B	C	D
Range	94+	84–86	70–76	60–69

Full scale is in the syllabus. A grade of **C or better** is required for this course to count toward a degree or certificate.

Dates to write down

Sept 21	First day of class
Week 5	Final project assigned
Oct 19–23	
Oct 28	Midterm — in class, on paper
Nov 11	No class — Veterans Day
Nov 25	No class — Thanksgiving
Nov 30	Final exam — in class, on paper
Dec 3	Last day to withdraw
Dec 4	Final project due 11:59 PM — firm
Dec 7–10	Finals week — project presentations

Weeks 8 and 10 have only **one** class session, and the final exam is the Monday right after Thanksgiving break. Review in Week 9, not over the holiday.

If things go sideways

Illness, work, family, a genuinely brutal week — **message me before the deadline** and we'll set a new date. I grant these. I just need to hear from you.

Almost every problem is solvable in Week 3 and much harder to solve in Week 10.